8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

10 REDUCED INEQUALITIES

Child Labour

STEP 1 RAISING AWARENESS

1 A **Work in pairs. Make a list of reasons why children may have to work.**

B **Compare your list with another pair and answer the following question:**

Do you think any of the reasons on your lists can justify child labour?

STEP 2 GOING AHEAD

2 A **Make a note of two things you know about child labour and two things you would like to learn about it.**

B **Read the information from the 2021 Report on Child Labor by the International Labor Organization (ILO). Look at your notes in Ex 2A and:**

- underline the parts of the text which confirm the information you already know.
- circle the new information.

C **Read the text again. Complete the gaps (1–7) with the phrases (a–g).**

a child labour is three times higher than

b as a consequence of a sharp rise in poverty caused by the COVID crisis

c almost one in ten children aged five or more

d which is the most important sector for child labour

e rose by more than 8 million

f are dangerous for their health, safety

g which has the largest share of children in the population in the world

D **Match the numbers (1–5) with what they refer to (a–e). Check your answers in the text.**

1 160 million is the total number of

2 63 million is the number of

3 97 million refers to the number of

4 4.7% is the percentage of

5 Over 25% is the percentage of

a child labour in towns and cities.

b female child labourers.

c child labourers between five and eleven who do not go to school.

d children aged five or over who are obliged to work.

e male child labourers.

Child labour: global estimates and trends

Child labour is a huge problem in the world today. About 160 million children – [1]..... – are engaged in child labour around the world. 79 million children are involved in activities that [2]..... and growth.

Unfortunately, between 2016 and 2020, the fight against child labour didn't make significant progress. The percentage of children in child labour remained the same as in the previous four years, while the total number of children involved in child labour [3]..... .

Studies suggest that even higher numbers of children will be involved in child labour [4]..... . The pandemic has demonstrated that there are challenges which require international cooperation for action to be taken at a global level. The goal is the elimination of child labour.

The ILO Report also states that:

- there are more boys than girls in child labour (63 million girls and 97 million boys).
- in rural areas [5]..... in urban areas (13.9% in rural areas; 4.7% in urban areas).
- 112 million children are employed in agriculture, [6]..... .
- over 25% of children aged five to eleven and over 33% of children aged twelve to fourteen who are engaged in child labour do not go to school.
- Africa, [7]..... , has seen a significant rise in the number of children in child labour since 2012. There are now more children in child labour in Africa than in the rest of the world.



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Language for citizenship

3 **Complete the text with the phrases in the box.**

outside school hours
under the minimum legal age
help your parents at home
don't interfere with your right to education

Some types of work done by children cannot be considered child labour. If, for example, you [1] ..... or if you work [2] ..... to earn some pocket money, that can't be classified as child labour because these activities [3] ..... or affect your personal growth.

Child labour also includes work done by children [4] ..... for that kind of work, which is usually defined by each country.

CRITICAL THINKING

The Italian Constitution

4 **Read the extracts from Artilce 37 of the Italian Constitution. Go online and find out the minimum legal age to start working in Italy.**

La legge stabilisce il limite minimo di età per il lavoro salariato.

La Repubblica tutela il lavoro dei minori con speciali norme e garantisce ad essi, a parità di lavoro, il diritto alla parità di retribuzione.

STEP 3 TAKING ACTION

Digital literacies

5A **Look at the description and example of an acrostic poem. What word does this one spell?**

An **acrostic poem** is based on a word written vertically. Read together, the first letters of each line spell out that word. All the lines of the poem are often connected to the meaning of the word.

Really think about the problem.
It is important.
Get together with your friends.
Help us
To
Save children.

B **Write an acrostic poem for the words 'CHILD LABOUR'. The words you choose should help to explain your understanding and feelings about the problem of child labour.**

C **Create a poster with your acrostic poem. Use all the acrostic poems from the class to create an exhibition to be displayed around your classroom.**



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